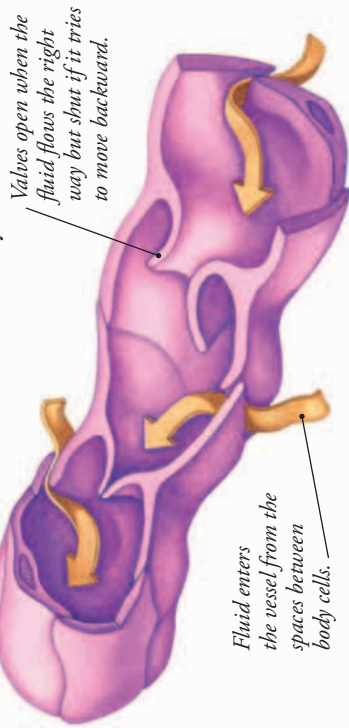


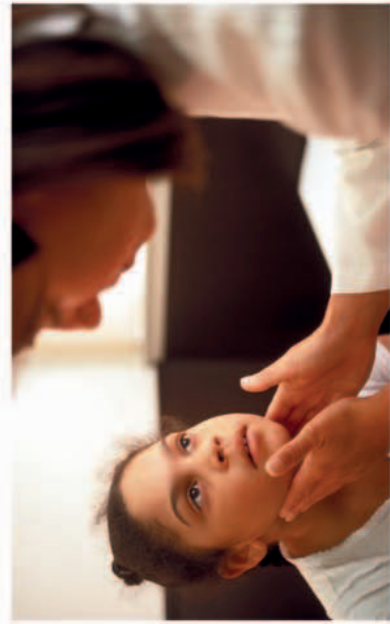
ONE-WAY FLOW

The fluid that the lymphatic system collects and filters is known as lymph. Unlike blood, lymph isn't pumped along by the heartbeat. Instead, it's pushed along more slowly whenever body movements squeeze lymphatic vessels. Valves inside the vessels make sure the fluid moves in one direction only.



SWOLLEN NODES

If a doctor feels the sides of your neck or the underside of your chin, you're being checked for swollen lymph nodes (also called "swollen glands," though they aren't glands). When your body is fighting an infection, your lymph nodes become more active and swell up.



INVADING WORMS

In some tropical countries, the bite of a mosquito can introduce tiny worms into the human body, causing a disease known as elephantiasis. The worms block lymphatic vessels in the legs, causing fluid to build up. Over time, the legs and feet swell up enormously until they look like the legs of an elephant. Scientists are trying to wipe out this disfiguring disease and think it will be eradicated completely by 2020.



▲ UNDER ATTACK Seen through a microscope at $\times 900$ magnification, white blood cells (colored yellow) attack the worm that causes elephantiasis.

